

Agreed to count fire detections. Counted cameras.

The Xcel Energy utility for most of the Texas Panhandle runs AI smoke cameras. The order approving its plan lists the number of AI camera fire detections among the metrics it agreed to report. Its annual report answered that line with a count of cameras.



The Tribune traces the fire to a pole.

The Tribune reports the Smokehouse Creek fire was the largest in Texas history. It says the fire started when a decayed Xcel Energy pole snapped and landed in dry grass. SPS testimony says its equipment "appeared to be involved in two ignitions" of the fire.

Two cameras turn. A person checks.

The SPS application says each camera site carries two cameras that rotate to detect smoke. A human operator verifies and forwards what they gather. SPS named Pano AI as its partner.

two physical cameras that rotate
verified and forwarded by a human
operator
shared with SPS and first
responders

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The order wrote the measure down.

The PUCT approved the SPS resiliency plan on July 10th, 2025, as modified by the parties' agreement. The order lists the number of AI camera fire detections among the agreed metrics SPS will carry into its annual reports.

j. number of artificial intelligence camera fire detections;

The answer counted cameras.

SPS filed its annual report on May 1st. Under the detections line it wrote 33 cameras installed and 34 projected for 2026. It says a partial year means actual effectiveness can't yet be compared with projections.

Number of artificial intelligence camera fire detections.

Actual: 33 cameras installed

Projected: 34 for 2026

One line filled. One left bare.

Each head on the top rail is one camera the report counts as installed. The lower rail is the line the order named. The report gives that line no count of detections. A missing count isn't a count of none.

Actual: 33 cameras installed

number of artificial intelligence camera fire detections



The cost was projected to the dollar.

For 2026 SPS anticipates \$10,537,400 of AI camera capital costs against \$6,423,554 in the plan. It calls that a 64.04% change.

PLAN \$6,423,554

ANTICIPATED \$10,537,400

Eight of 160 utilities had filed.

The Tribune reports that count from a House hearing on wildfire mitigation plans, a different rule from resiliency plans. Four more had given a filing date and 135 were preparing plans. The PUCT's blueprint lists cameras as a "Suggested" tool, not a requirement.



ONE SEAT FOR EACH UTILITY THE HEARING COUNTED

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How many fires have the cameras detected?

Both filings are public on the PUCT Interchange, the order in Docket 57463 and the May 1st report in Project 57941. SPS says its 2027 annual report will carry a full year of data. Under the order that report will carry the same detections line.